Pakistan would henceforth have to pay a blood-for-blood price for any misadventure it dared to undertake. India's fresh resolve was evident soon enough when, in response to a terror strike at an army camp in Uri in September 2016, Modi ordered surgical strikes across the Line of Control (LoC). Three years later, in February 2019, the PM cleared air force jets to strike a terror camp in Balakot right inside Pakistani territory after a car suicide bombing in Pulwama killed 40 personnel of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF). Six months later, shortly after being elected prime minister for the second time, Modi took the watershed step of abrogating Article 370, which bestowed special status on Jammu and Kashmir. That put a formal closure on Pakistan's dubious claims over the Valley, though it didn't stop Pakistan army chief General Asim Munir from describing it as his country's "jugular vein" in a recent speech.

Following the Pahalgam attack, Modi has drawn thick new red lines in dealing with Pakistan-backed terror attacks. These entail a quantum jump in punitive measures, based on three simple principles, as external affairs minister S. Jaishankar communicated to the major world powers, including the US and China, before India struck. Jaishankar reportedly told them that firstly, India's retribution against terror would increase exponentially; secondly, both terrorists and their sponsors (read Pakistan) would be held accountable and, thirdly, India would ensure they were brought to justice. Multiple vectors—political, military, economic and psychological—would be employed to achieve these objectives. India had already exercised the political option when it decided to suspend the 65-year-old Indus



Explosions at Nur Khan air base near Rawalpindi light up the night sky after strikes by Indian missiles, May 10

ANI



DAY 3

MAY 9 2030 HRS ONWARDS

- Pakistan launches third wave against 26 locations—Operation Bunyan Marsoos—trying to strike Indian military bases. India accuses Pakistan of attacking civilian areas and religious sites, with drones, heavy artillery
- Pakistani Fatah-II missile, aimed at "an important base", reportedly Delhi, is intercepted over Sirsa. India releases images of undamaged air bases to counter Pakistan's claims of inflicted damage
- India expands operation, targeting Pakistani military installations. Intense aerial engagements. Pakistan struggles to penetrate Indian air defences

PTI



Villages like this—Salamabad in Uri, in Kashmir—bore the brunt of Pakistani shelling

DAY 4

MAY 10 AFTER 0140 HRS

- Pakistan expands attacks on air bases in Punjab. J&K targeted with missiles. Civilian areas near Amritsar targeted too
- India hits eight Pak air bases—Murid (Chakwal), Sukkur, Rahim Yar Khan, Bholari, Rafiqui, Shahbaz (Jacobabad), Mushaf (Sargodha) and Nur Khan (Chaklala/ Rawalpindi)
- Military installations, command centres, radar sites, weapon storage areas targeted
- With Nur Khan close to Pak army HQ and the Strategic Plans Division, the operational arm of its nuclear command, tensions rise
- Reports from Pakistan claim the National Command Authority, which controls its nuclear response, has convened. Later denied
- Heavy artillery, mortar fire exchanged in Kupwara, Baramulla, Poonch, Rajouri, Akhnoor sectors of J&K
- Pakistan reports 31 civilian deaths and 57 injuries overall, while India reports 12 deaths and 57 injuries from overnight Pakistani shelling

1700 HRS Ceasefire comes into effect

-Pradip R. Sagar